SPOTIFY GROWTH STRATEGY

Spotify Has Solved Recommendation — T
Meaningful Discovery

Spotify has millions of songs and world-class recommendation systems. Yet users are trapped in a loop: replaying familiar playlists, listening to known artists, and struggling to find the right new music.

100M+
Tracks available

3/5
Repetition fatigue rating

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THE DISCOVERY PROBLEM

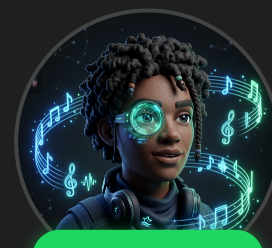
Users Are Not Searching for More Songs - for the Right Feeling

Risk Averse

The Comfort Listener

"I keep playing the same playlist because discovery feels risky."

- Replays favorite content to match mood baseline
- Avoids radio features due to high skip fatigue
- Values absolute predictability over novelty



Appetite Rich

The Explorer

"I want new music but don't k where to start."

- Overwhelmed by Spotify's massi 100M+ catalog
- Suffers from severe discovery ch paralysis
- Desires curated pathways, not op ended search

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PHASE 1: SCALE ANALYSIS

AI Analysis of Millions of Conversations R Discovery Frictions

To map user pain points at scale, we deployed an AI review engine that continuously crawls and categorizes app reviews, community discussions, and social comments.

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Key AI Engine Insight

Collaborative filtering is creating local optima. Users get trapped in hyper-focused recommendation clusters that feel repetitive, predictable, and artificial.

Try Deployed Discovery Engine Prototype

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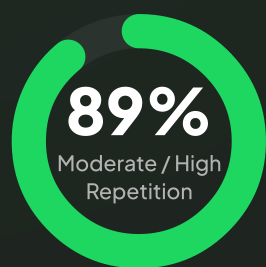
PHASE 2: SURVEY INSIGHTS

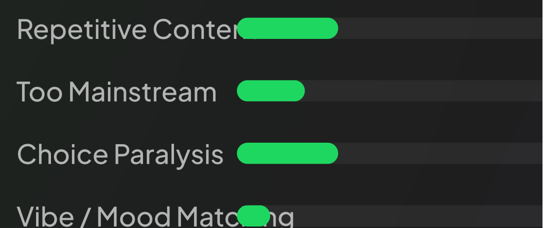
User Research Confirmed Recommendat

Perceived Recommendation Repetition



89% of respondents who answered rated repetition at **3/5** or higher.

Primary Discovery Roadblock



Users suffer from three equally painful, systemic issues.

"Users want active discovery guidance, not ar

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PROBLEM DEFINITION

Survey Insights Show a Gap Between Spo
User Intent

What Spotify ML Mastered

- **Listening History:** Detailed logging of every track, skip, and duration.
- **Behavioral Vectors:** High-dimensional embeddings mapping artist affinities.
- **Collaborative Similarity:** Grouping users with matching historical profiles.

➔

What Current ML Fails to Grasp

- **Immediate Context:** Why a user's intent changed from their history.
- **Emotional State:** The nuanced feeling they want to capture *now*.
- **Conversational Steerability:** Explaining *why* they want something different.

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STRATEGIC FRAMING

The Opportunity: Move From Predicting T Understanding Intent

THE PROBLEM STATEMENT

"For Spotify users who want to discover new music, our current reco specific, context-dependent discovery goal. The root cause is a lim driving users to rely on manual curations or replay familiar lists."

Business Growth Opportunities

🚀

Increase Engagement

Unlock new active listening sessions by providing steerable, rewarding discovery interfaces.

🛡️

Reduce User Churn

Address the "chronic repetition fatigue" (3/5 score) before users explore alternative platforms.

🎵

Long-tail

Shift consu represente accurately intent.

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SYSTEM DESIGN

AI Unlocks a New Discovery Experience I
Traditional Systems

Dimension	Traditional Recommendation
Input Core	Implicit past behavior (skips, track durations, play counts)
System Architecture	Collaborative Filtering & Matrix Factorization
Exploration Control	None (locked system profile defaults)
Transparency Layer	Black-box recommendations
Feedback Latency	High (requires days of skips to update matrix profiles)

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PHASE 4 MVP PROTOTYPE

AI Discovery Companion Turns a Music Se Conversation

We built and deployed a functional MVP demonstrating how conversational AI can guide discovery based on context rather than catalog history.

- **Natural Language Steering:**
  Users describe their exact mood, environment, or prompt.
- **Steerable Exploration:**
  Discovery Slider modulates recommendations between familiar hits and niche gems.
- **Explainable Curation:**
  AI explicitly details *why* a track matches the conversational prompt.

Try Deployed Streamlit MVP

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GROWTH MECHANICS

The MVP Creates a New Spotify Growth L

By letting users steer recommendations explicitly, we build trust, increase catalog exposure, and capture more explicit state indicators.

Traditional Passive Loop (Stagnant)

Passive play ➔ System repeats catalog based on history ➔ Safe but predictable behavior ➔ Interest stagnation.

AI-Native Discovery Loop (Growth)

User defines prompt & slider ➔ AI exposes niche long-tail artists ➔ Accurate fit drives library saves ➔ Better taste graph models.

AI shifts Spotify from: **"Spotify predicts what you like"** to **"Spoti**

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LEADERSHIP SUMMARY

AI-Powered Discovery Can Become Spo Engagement Engine

Impact for Listeners

🎵 **Meaningful Discovery:** Effortless transition to new genres.

🧠 **Emotional Curation:** Deep feeling of being understood by the app.

❌ **Break Repetition Loop:** Instant escape pathway from catalog staleness.

Impact for Spotify

📈 **Higher Engagement:** Longer session counts and deeper sessions.

🛡️ **Improved Retention:** Reduces churn by solving recommendation fatigue.

🌱 **Artist Ecosystem:** Distributes organic plays across a broader library.

Future Product Roadmap

PHASE 1 (COMPLETED)
AI Discovery Engine

PHASE 2 (COMPLETED)
Primary Research

PHASE 4 (LIVE)
Discovery MVP

PHASE 5 (ROADMAP)
Real-Time Biometric Mood

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